



P 3 8 · 2 4 P A G E S , 3 0 R E C I P E S , P R I N T A B L E

Postpartum Freezer Meal Cookbook

A small cookbook of thirty recipes designed for the postpartum stretch. All are freezer-friendly. All are one-handed-eating compatible. Soups and stews, curries and bowls, casseroles, make-ahead breakfasts, and a pack of snacks and smoothies. With a pre-cook-day grocery list, a kitchen-organization page, a freezer map, and a reheating reference. Indian-friendly options throughout.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note from the maker

The first six weeks of postpartum are not a season for ambitious cooking.

By the time you have figured out how to nurse without using your dominant hand, how to burp without putting the kid down, how to pee while holding the baby because they cry when you set them down, you do not have the bandwidth to dice an onion.

This cookbook is for that season. Every recipe is one-handed compatible. Every recipe is freezer-friendly. Every recipe is a partner's "what do I make tonight" answered before the question.

The pre-cook day is a real thing. Not the day before delivery, you will be too pregnant. Two weeks before is the right window. Or your partner does it the day after delivery while you are still at the hospital. Or your mother does it when she visits. Or a meal-train friend does it.

What you eat in the postpartum window matters. Not because you have to lose weight (you do not). Not because there are foods that make milk (the body does that). But because eating well makes a tired person less tired. Eating well makes a sad person less sad. Eating well is one of the cheapest things you can do for yourself, in a season when expensive things are not available.

With care, Maya

This is a cookbook, not medical advice. Allergies and dietary restrictions in your household are between you and your provider. Adjust freely.

How to use this cookbook

- Print, or keep on a tablet. Some pages will get marked up.
- The pre-cook-day grocery list is at the front. Use it once. Reuse later.
- Recipes are grouped by category. Pick three or four from each category for a balanced freezer.
- Each recipe has rough yield, prep time, total time, freezer life, and the “one-handed verdict” (can you eat this with a fork, with the baby on the boob, at 11pm).
- Swap notes are on every recipe. Adapt freely. The recipe is a starting place.

The one-handed eating principle

What does "one-handed compatible" mean.

It means:

- A fork, not a knife.
- A spoon for soft food, not a pair of chopsticks.
- Food you can lift to your mouth without dripping on the baby.
- Food that is good warm but also tolerable lukewarm, because you will not finish it before it cools.
- Food that does not require active stirring or attention while you eat.

It does not mean:

- Soggy.
- Tasteless.
- Stuff that comes in a foil packet.

The constraint is the hand. The food can still be good.

A small rule: every postpartum recipe should be edible at three temperatures: hot (the partner just made it), warm (you got to it within 20 minutes), and lukewarm (you got distracted).

Soups pass. Stir-fries don't always.

Pre-cook day, the grocery list

Print this. Tape to the fridge. Cross off as you shop. Best to do one big shop and one cooking afternoon.

PROTEINS

- ☐ Chicken thighs (boneless), 3 lbs
- ☐ Ground beef or ground turkey, 2 lbs
- ☐ Eggs, 2 dozen
- ☐ Dried lentils (red + brown), 1 lb each
- ☐ Canned beans (black, kidney, chickpeas), 6 cans
- ☐ Firm tofu, 2 blocks
- ☐ Salmon fillets, 1 lb (optional)
- ☐ Greek yogurt (large container)
- ☐ Hard cheese (cheddar, parmesan)

VEGETABLES (sturdy ones that freeze well)

- ☐ Yellow onions, bag
- ☐ Garlic, 2 heads
- ☐ Fresh ginger, 4 inches
- ☐ Carrots, 2 lbs
- ☐ Celery, 1 bunch
- ☐ Sweet potatoes, 3 lbs
- ☐ Spinach (frozen or fresh)
- ☐ Bell peppers, 4
- ☐ Tomatoes (canned, whole + crushed), 6 cans
- ☐ Coconut milk (full fat), 4 cans
- ☐ Frozen mixed vegetables, 1 large bag

PANTRY

- ☐ Brown rice, 5 lbs
- ☐ Quinoa, 1 lb
- ☐ Steel-cut oats, 1 lb
- ☐ Whole-wheat tortillas (large), 12
- ☐ Pasta (penne, rotini), 2 lbs
- ☐ Marinara sauce (jarred), 4 jars
- ☐ Chicken or vegetable broth, 4 quarts
- ☐ Coconut oil, olive oil
- ☐ Soy sauce, fish sauce, vinegar

SPICES (small amounts of many)

- ☐ Salt, pepper, cumin, coriander, turmeric
- ☐ Garam masala, curry powder
- ☐ Smoked paprika, oregano, thyme
- ☐ Chili powder, red pepper flakes
- ☐ Bay leaves, cinnamon sticks

FOR SNACKS

- ☐ Nut butter (peanut, almond)
- ☐ Whole-grain bread
- ☐ Bananas, apples, oranges
- ☐ Cheese sticks
- ☐ Roasted nuts (almonds, cashews)
- ☐ Granola bars
- ☐ Dark chocolate (this is not optional)

CONTAINERS

- ☐ Freezer-safe containers in 1 cup and 2 cup sizes
- ☐ Quart-size freezer bags, large box
- ☐ Gallon-size freezer bags, medium box
- ☐ Sharpie + masking tape for labels

Kitchen orientation for the cooking day

What you need. What you do not need.

Earns its space:

- One large pot (5 to 7 quart). Soups, stews, curries.
- One large skillet (12 inch). Onions, ground meat, sauteed vegetables.
- One sheet pan (rimmed). Roasting batches.
- A good sharp knife. One is enough.
- A cutting board.
- A pressure cooker or slow cooker (either, not both required). Lifesaver.
- A blender or food processor. For smoothies and purees.
- A wooden spoon. A spatula. A ladle.
- Measuring cups + spoons.

Skip:

- Any specialty appliance you do not already own.
- Anything you have to assemble.
- Anything that takes more counter space than your usable counter.

Labels matter. Every container or bag goes in the freezer with:

- What it is (so future-you does not have to guess)
- Date frozen
- How to reheat in one sentence

A masking-tape label + Sharpie is enough.

Soups + stews

The first 48 hours of postpartum are often best handled with broth-based food. Easy to reheat. Easy to eat lying down. Easy on a tender system.

1. White chicken chili

Hearty, mild, freezer-friendly. Indian and Latin pantry-compatible.

Yield: 8 servings **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 1 hour **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, in a bowl with a spoon

Ingredients:

- 2 lb chicken thighs (boneless)
- 2 cans white beans (great northern), drained
- 1 large yellow onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 2 cans diced green chilies
- 2 tsp cumin, 2 tsp oregano, 1 tsp coriander
- 1 quart chicken broth
- Salt + pepper
- 1 cup sour cream or Greek yogurt (added when reheating, not freezing)

Method:

1. Saute onion + garlic in pot until soft.
2. Add chicken, broth, spices, beans, chilies. Simmer 30 min.
3. Shred chicken with two forks in the pot.
4. Cool. Portion into containers. Freeze.
5. To reheat: thaw overnight or use defrost. Warm in microwave. Stir in yogurt or sour cream just before eating.

Swap notes: Vegetarian version, swap chicken for 2 cans of chickpeas + 1 cup mushrooms. Dairy-free, skip the yogurt or use coconut cream.

2. Lentil-vegetable soup

The "I have no energy" soup. Vegan if you want.

Yield: 8 servings **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 45 min **Freezer life:** 4 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 2 cups red lentils
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 carrots, diced
- 3 celery stalks, diced
- 4 cloves garlic
- 1 can crushed tomatoes
- 2 quarts broth (vegetable or chicken)
- 2 tsp cumin, 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp coriander
- Juice of 1 lemon (added at reheating)
- Salt + pepper

Method:

1. Saute onion, carrot, celery in pot 5 min.
2. Add garlic, lentils, tomatoes, broth, spices. Simmer 25 min.
3. Cool. Portion. Freeze flat in bags.
4. To reheat: warm in microwave or stovetop. Stir in lemon juice at the end.

Swap notes: Indian version, add 1 tsp garam masala + a piece of fresh ginger. Topped with cilantro and yogurt when serving.

3. Beef + barley stew

Hearty, sticks-to-your-bones. The 11pm partner meal.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 20 min **Total:** 90 min in slow cooker **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, with a spoon

Ingredients:

- 1.5 lb stew beef, cubed
- 1 cup pearl barley
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 carrots, sliced
- 3 celery stalks, sliced
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 quart beef broth
- 1 can diced tomatoes
- 2 tbsp tomato paste
- 2 bay leaves, salt + pepper

Method:

1. Brown beef in pot.
2. Add everything else.
3. Slow cooker 6 hours on low, or stovetop simmer 90 min.
4. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
5. To reheat: thaw, warm slowly. The barley will absorb liquid, add water or broth.

Swap notes: Use ground beef if you do not want to cube. Vegetarian, swap beef for mushrooms + lentils.

4. Tomato-coconut soup

Creamy without dairy. Indian-comforting.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 30 min **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 2 cans crushed tomatoes
- 1 can full-fat coconut milk
- 1 onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic
- 1 inch ginger, grated
- 2 tsp curry powder, 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp coriander
- 1 cup broth
- Salt + pepper
- Cilantro for garnish (not frozen)

Method:

1. Saute onion, garlic, ginger.
2. Add tomatoes, coconut milk, spices, broth. Simmer 20 min.
3. Blend with immersion blender for smooth, or leave chunky.
4. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
5. Reheat slowly so coconut milk does not separate.

Swap notes: Add a can of chickpeas for protein. Stir in spinach at reheating.

5. Chicken-rice porridge (congee or khichdi-style)

Soft, easy on a recovering system. Comfort food.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 1 hour **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, very

Ingredients:

- 1 cup brown rice
- 1 lb chicken thighs
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 cloves garlic
- 1 inch ginger, grated
- 2 quarts broth
- 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp salt
- Soy sauce + green onions to garnish

Method:

1. Combine rice, chicken, onion, garlic, ginger, broth, spices in pot.
2. Simmer 1 hour until rice has broken down into porridge consistency.
3. Shred chicken in the pot.
4. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
5. Reheat with extra broth or water (it will thicken on standing).

Swap notes: South Asian khichdi-style, swap chicken for moong dal and add a pinch of asafoetida. Garnish with ghee.

6. Black bean + sweet potato chili

Vegetarian, freezer queen, the friend's drop-off meal.

Yield: 8 servings **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 45 min **Freezer life:** 4 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 3 cans black beans, drained
- 2 large sweet potatoes, cubed
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic
- 1 can crushed tomatoes
- 1 can chipotle in adobo (use 1 to 2 peppers, mince)
- 2 tsp cumin, 1 tsp smoked paprika, 1 tsp coriander
- 1 quart broth
- Juice of 1 lime (at reheating)
- Salt + pepper

Method:

1. Saute onion + garlic.
2. Add sweet potato, beans, tomato, chipotle, broth, spices.
3. Simmer 30 min, until sweet potato is tender.
4. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
5. Reheat, finish with lime.

Swap notes: Add ground turkey or ground beef for non-vegetarian. Skip chipotle if you cannot do spicy postpartum.

Curries + one-pot bowls

Curries freeze beautifully. Rice cooks fresh while you reheat. Indian-friendly throughout.

7. Coconut chickpea curry

Pantry curry. No fresh ingredients required.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 35 min **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, over rice

Ingredients:

- 2 cans chickpeas, drained
- 1 can crushed tomatoes
- 1 can full-fat coconut milk
- 1 onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 inch ginger, grated
- 1 tbsp curry powder, 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp cumin, 1 tsp garam masala
- 1 cup broth
- Salt
- Cilantro for garnish at serving

Method:

1. Saute onion, garlic, ginger.
2. Add spices, toast 30 seconds.
3. Add tomatoes, coconut milk, chickpeas, broth. Simmer 25 min.
4. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
5. Reheat. Serve over rice.

Swap notes: Add spinach at the end for greens. Add cubed chicken thighs at step 1 for protein.

8. Lentil dal

The "I miss home" food.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 40 min **Freezer life:** 4 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, over rice

Ingredients:

- 1.5 cups red lentils (masoor dal)
- 1 onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 inch ginger, grated
- 2 tomatoes, chopped (or 1 can diced)
- 2 tsp cumin, 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp coriander, 1/2 tsp red chili powder
- 6 cups water or broth
- 2 tbsp ghee or oil
- 1 tsp cumin seeds, 1 dried red chili (for tempering, optional)
- Cilantro at serving

Method:

1. Rinse lentils. Combine with onion, tomato, spices, water. Simmer 30 min.
2. Heat ghee separately. Add cumin seeds + chili until fragrant. Pour over dal.
3. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
4. Reheat with a splash of water (it thickens).

Swap notes: Vegan, use oil instead of ghee. Add spinach at reheating.

9. Thai-style red curry with vegetables

Mild, sweet-savory, satisfying.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 30 min **Freezer life:** 2 months (vegetables get softer)

One-handed verdict: yes, over rice

Ingredients:

- 1 can coconut milk
- 3 tbsp red curry paste (jarred)
- 1 lb chicken thighs, cubed (or tofu, or chickpeas)
- 1 bell pepper, sliced
- 1 cup frozen green beans
- 1 cup chopped sweet potato
- 2 tbsp fish sauce (or soy sauce for vegetarian)
- 1 tbsp brown sugar
- Juice of 1 lime (at serving)
- Basil for garnish (fresh, not frozen)

Method:

1. Heat coconut milk + curry paste in pot.
2. Add protein + vegetables. Simmer 20 min.
3. Add fish sauce, sugar.
4. Cool. Portion. Freeze.
5. Reheat, finish with lime.

Swap notes: Add a can of chickpeas for extra protein.

10. Beef + sweet potato curry

A hearty curry that holds up overnight.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 20 min **Total:** 90 min **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, over rice

Ingredients:

- 1.5 lb beef chuck, cubed
- 2 sweet potatoes, cubed
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 inch ginger, grated
- 2 tbsp curry powder, 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp cumin
- 1 can coconut milk
- 1 cup broth
- Salt + pepper

Method:

1. Brown beef in pot.
2. Add onion, garlic, ginger. Saute.
3. Add spices, sweet potato, coconut milk, broth.
4. Simmer 75 min until beef is tender.
5. Cool. Portion. Freeze.

Swap notes: Lamb instead of beef. Add raisins for sweetness.

11. Mexican chicken-rice bowl base

The base for a quick taco-bowl assembly.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 30 min **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, in a bowl

Ingredients:

- 1.5 lb chicken thighs
- 1 cup rice (cooked separately for fresh rice)
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 can black beans, drained
- 1 can corn, drained
- 1 can diced tomatoes
- 2 tsp cumin, 1 tsp smoked paprika, 1 tsp oregano
- 1 cup broth
- Lime + cilantro at serving

Method:

1. Saute onion. Add chicken, brown.
2. Add beans, corn, tomatoes, spices, broth. Simmer 20 min.
3. Shred chicken in pot.
4. Cool. Portion the protein-bean-corn mixture (not the rice). Freeze.
5. Reheat. Serve over fresh-cooked rice. Top with whatever you have, avocado, yogurt, cheese, salsa.

Swap notes: Vegetarian, double the black beans + add a can of pinto.

12. Indian potato + pea curry (aloo matar)

Comfort. Pantry. Cheap.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 40 min **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, over rice or with rotis

Ingredients:

- 4 medium potatoes, cubed
- 2 cups frozen peas
- 1 large onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic
- 1 inch ginger, grated
- 1 can crushed tomatoes
- 2 tsp cumin, 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp coriander, 1 tsp garam masala
- 1.5 cups water
- 2 tbsp oil or ghee
- Cilantro at serving

Method:

1. Saute onion in oil.
2. Add garlic, ginger, spices.
3. Add tomatoes, potatoes, water. Simmer 25 min.
4. Add peas in last 5 min.
5. Cool. Portion. Freeze.

Swap notes: Add paneer cubes at the end for protein. Use cauliflower instead of (or with) potato.

Casseroles + bakes

Make once, eat for three days. Freezer-aged, even better.

13. Baked ziti

The friend's drop-off meal. Reliable as gravity.

Yield: 8 servings **Prep:** 25 min **Total:** 1 hour **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, with a fork

Ingredients:

- 1 lb ziti or penne
- 2 jars marinara sauce
- 1 lb ground beef or Italian sausage
- 1 onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic
- 2 cups ricotta cheese
- 2 cups mozzarella, shredded
- 1/2 cup parmesan
- 1 egg
- Italian herbs

Method:

1. Cook pasta al dente. Drain.
2. Brown meat with onion + garlic.
3. Add marinara to meat.
4. Mix ricotta + egg.
5. Layer in baking dish: meat sauce, pasta, ricotta mixture, mozzarella. Repeat.
6. Top with parmesan.
7. Cool. Wrap tightly. Freeze whole, or portion into containers.

8. Bake from frozen at 375 for 45 min covered, then 15 min uncovered.

Swap notes: Vegetarian, skip meat, add roasted vegetables. Gluten-free pasta works.

14. Chicken + rice casserole

Slightly retro, perfect comfort.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 1 hour **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 1.5 lb chicken thighs
- 1.5 cups rice
- 3 cups broth
- 1 onion, chopped
- 1 cup frozen mixed vegetables
- 1 can cream-of-mushroom-style soup
- 1 cup shredded cheese
- Salt + pepper, paprika

Method:

1. In baking dish, combine rice, broth, soup, onion, vegetables, spices.
2. Lay chicken on top.
3. Cover. Bake at 375 for 50 min.
4. Uncover, top with cheese, bake 10 more min.
5. Cool. Portion. Freeze.

Swap notes: Use cauliflower rice instead of rice (less liquid).

15. Lasagna with hidden vegetables

Classic. Hides spinach in plain sight.

Yield: 10 servings **Prep:** 40 min **Total:** 1.5 hours **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 12 lasagna noodles
- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 onion, chopped
- 4 cloves garlic
- 2 jars marinara
- 1 box frozen spinach, thawed + drained
- 2 cups ricotta
- 3 cups mozzarella
- 1/2 cup parmesan
- 1 egg

Method:

1. Cook noodles to just-soft.
2. Brown meat with onion + garlic. Add marinara.
3. Mix ricotta + egg + spinach.
4. Layer in 9×13: sauce, noodles, ricotta, mozzarella. Repeat.
5. Top with parmesan.
6. Wrap tightly. Freeze.
7. Bake from frozen at 375, 60-75 min covered, then 15 min uncovered.

Swap notes: Vegetarian, skip the meat and add layers of roasted zucchini.

16. Enchilada bake

Lighter than enchiladas, easier to make.

Yield: 8 servings **Prep:** 30 min **Total:** 1 hour **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, with a fork

Ingredients:

- 8 flour or corn tortillas, cut in quarters
- 1.5 lb chicken (rotisserie works), shredded
- 1 can black beans
- 1 can corn
- 2 cans enchilada sauce
- 2 cups shredded cheese
- 1 onion, chopped
- Cumin, chili powder

Method:

1. Saute onion, mix with chicken, beans, corn, spices.
2. Layer in 9×13: sauce, tortillas, chicken mix, cheese. Repeat.
3. Cool. Wrap. Freeze.
4. Bake from frozen at 375 for 45 min covered, 15 uncovered.

Swap notes: Vegetarian, swap chicken for 2 cans beans + cooked sweet potato.

17. Shepherd's pie (or vegetarian version)

Mashed potatoes on top of seasoned filling. Everyone eats it.

Yield: 6 servings **Prep:** 30 min **Total:** 1 hour **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 1.5 lb ground beef or ground turkey
- 1 onion, chopped
- 3 carrots, diced
- 1 cup frozen peas
- 2 cloves garlic
- 1 tbsp tomato paste
- 1 cup broth
- 4 lbs potatoes, mashed
- 1/2 cup milk, 4 tbsp butter (for mash)
- Salt + pepper

Method:

1. Brown meat with onion + carrots + garlic.
2. Add tomato paste, broth, peas. Simmer 10 min.
3. Spread in baking dish. Top with mashed potatoes.
4. Cool. Wrap. Freeze.
5. Bake from frozen at 375 for 60 min until top is golden.

Swap notes: Vegetarian, swap meat for cooked lentils + mushrooms.

18. Breakfast strata (egg + bread bake)

Make tonight. Eat for three breakfasts.

Yield: 8 servings **Prep:** 15 min + overnight **Total:** 1.5 hours **Freezer life:** 1 month (best fresh)

One-handed verdict: yes

Ingredients:

- 8 cups cubed bread (day-old works)
- 8 eggs
- 3 cups milk
- 2 cups shredded cheese
- 1 cup sauteed vegetables (spinach + onion + mushroom)
- 1/2 lb cooked sausage or bacon, chopped (optional)
- Salt + pepper

Method:

1. Mix bread, vegetables, meat, cheese in baking dish.
2. Whisk eggs + milk. Pour over.
3. Refrigerate overnight.
4. Bake at 350 for 1 hour.
5. Cool. Portion. Refrigerate or freeze portions.

Swap notes: Skip meat. Use gluten-free bread. Add herbs.

Breakfast + make-ahead

The 3am feed needs food. So does the 6am one. Make-ahead breakfast is the difference between eating and not.

19. Steel-cut overnight oats (one pot, a week of breakfasts)

Make Sunday night. Eat Monday through Friday.

Yield: 5 servings **Prep:** 5 min **Total:** overnight **Freezer life:** 1 month **One-handed verdict:** yes, with a spoon

Ingredients:

- 1.5 cups steel-cut oats
- 6 cups water
- 1/2 tsp salt
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- Toppings (added at eating, not freezing): nut butter, banana, berries, milk, honey

Method:

1. Bring water + salt + cinnamon to boil.
2. Add oats. Reduce to low. Cook 25 min.
3. Cool. Portion into 5 jars or containers.
4. Refrigerate up to 5 days. Or freeze for up to a month.
5. Reheat with a splash of milk in microwave. Top.

Swap notes: Make savory, swap cinnamon for salt + pepper, top with egg + greens.

20. Make-ahead breakfast burritos

The 9am-after-night-shift meal.

Yield: 10 burritos **Prep:** 30 min **Total:** 45 min **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, the whole point

Ingredients:

- 10 large flour tortillas
- 12 eggs, scrambled
- 1 lb sausage or 2 cups roasted sweet potato cubes
- 2 cups shredded cheese
- 1 can black beans, drained
- Salsa

Method:

1. Scramble eggs.
2. Cook sausage or roast sweet potato.
3. Lay out tortillas. Fill each with eggs, sausage/potato, beans, cheese, salsa.
4. Roll, tucking in sides.
5. Wrap each in parchment + foil.
6. Freeze in a gallon bag.
7. To reheat: microwave 2 min, then 1 min more. Or oven from frozen 25 min at 375.

Swap notes: Vegetarian filling, skip sausage. Hot sauce + avocado at eating.

21. Savory muffins (egg + cheese)

*E*at with one hand. Toddler-friendly too.

Yield: 12 muffins **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 35 min **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, the most one-handed thing here

Ingredients:

- 8 eggs
- 1 cup milk
- 1 cup shredded cheese
- 1 cup chopped vegetables (spinach, peppers, onions)
- 1/2 lb cooked sausage or bacon, crumbled
- Salt + pepper

Method:

1. Whisk eggs + milk + salt.
2. Stir in cheese, vegetables, meat.
3. Pour into muffin tin (greased or lined).
4. Bake at 350 for 20-25 min.
5. Cool. Freeze in a gallon bag.
6. Reheat: 60 seconds in microwave.

Swap notes: Add herbs. Swap meat for mushrooms.

22. Banana-oat-nut-butter freezer pancakes

Make a big batch. Reheat in toaster.

Yield: 16 pancakes **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 30 min **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 2 cups rolled oats, blended into flour
- 2 ripe bananas
- 4 eggs
- 1/2 cup nut butter
- 1/2 cup milk
- 1 tsp baking powder, 1 tsp cinnamon, pinch of salt
- Optional, chocolate chips or berries

Method:

1. Blend everything until smooth.
2. Cook on griddle, 2 min per side.
3. Cool completely.
4. Stack with parchment between pancakes. Freeze in gallon bag.
5. Reheat in toaster.

Swap notes: Skip eggs for vegan version, add 1 tbsp ground flax + 3 tbsp water per egg.

23. Greek yogurt parfait cups (refrigerator)

Not freezer. Refrigerator. 5 days of breakfast.

Yield: 5 cups **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 15 min **Refrigerator life:** 5 days **One-handed verdict:** yes, in a jar with a spoon

Ingredients:

- 5 jars or containers
- 5 cups Greek yogurt
- 1 cup granola (kept separate, added at eating)
- 1 cup berries (frozen or fresh)
- Honey or maple syrup
- Optional, nuts, chia seeds

Method:

1. Layer yogurt + berries + honey in each jar.
2. Refrigerate up to 5 days.
3. Add granola at eating (otherwise it gets soggy).

Swap notes: Use coconut yogurt for dairy-free. Add nut butter for protein.

24. Smoothie freezer packs

Pre-portioned. Dump into blender. 60 seconds to breakfast.

Yield: 6 packs **Prep:** 20 min **Total:** 20 min **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, smoothie in a glass

Ingredients per pack:

- 1 banana (sliced)
- 1/2 cup berries
- 1/2 cup spinach
- 1 tbsp nut butter
- 1 tbsp chia or flax seeds
- Optional, protein powder

Method:

1. Combine all in a quart-size freezer bag. Label.
2. Freeze flat.
3. To use: dump bag in blender. Add 1 cup milk or yogurt. Blend.

Swap notes: Use whatever frozen fruit you have. Avocado adds creaminess.

Snacks + smoothies + small things

The 3am feed needs more than the parent thinks. So does the 11am window when the baby finally napped. Keep small food everywhere.

25. Lactation-friendly oatmeal cookies (no claims, just good)

We do not claim they boost supply. We do claim they are delicious and easy.

Yield: 24 cookies **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 30 min **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, the most yes

Ingredients:

- 1 cup butter, softened
- 3/4 cup brown sugar
- 1/2 cup white sugar
- 2 eggs
- 1 tsp vanilla
- 2 cups rolled oats
- 2 cups flour
- 1 cup chocolate chips
- 1/4 cup ground flax
- 2 tbsp brewer's yeast (optional)
- 1 tsp baking soda, 1 tsp salt
- 1 tsp cinnamon

Method:

1. Cream butter + sugars.
2. Add eggs + vanilla.
3. Stir in dry ingredients.

4. Bake at 350 for 12 min.

5. Cool. Freeze in a gallon bag.

Swap notes: Skip brewer's yeast and ground flax for regular oatmeal cookies. Swap chocolate chips for raisins or dried cranberries.

26. Energy bites (no-bake)

Make Sunday. Eat all week.

Yield: 24 bites **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 15 min + chill **Refrigerator life:** 2 weeks **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 1 cup peanut butter
- 1/2 cup honey or maple syrup
- 2 cups rolled oats
- 1/2 cup ground flax
- 1/2 cup mini chocolate chips
- 1/2 cup chopped dates or raisins
- 1 tsp vanilla
- Pinch of salt

Method:

1. Mix everything in a bowl.
2. Roll into balls (1 inch).
3. Refrigerate 30 min to set.
4. Store in fridge or freeze.

Swap notes: Use almond butter. Add coconut. Add cinnamon.

27. Hardboiled eggs (the 3am protein)

Not glamorous. Saves your life at 3am.

Yield: 12 **Prep:** 5 min **Total:** 15 min **Refrigerator life:** 1 week **One-handed verdict:** depends, more like one and a half hands

Method:

1. Place eggs in pot. Cover with cold water.
2. Bring to boil. Remove from heat. Cover. Let sit 12 min.
3. Drain. Ice bath. Peel.
4. Store peeled in fridge.

A reminder: keep them peeled and visible at eye level in the fridge so you actually eat them.

28. Banana-bread loaves (mini)

Mini loaves freeze better than one big loaf.

Yield: 4 mini loaves **Prep:** 15 min **Total:** 45 min **Freezer life:** 3 months **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients:

- 4 ripe bananas
- 2 eggs
- 1/3 cup melted butter or oil
- 1/2 cup brown sugar
- 1/2 cup yogurt
- 2 cups flour
- 1 tsp baking soda, 1 tsp baking powder, pinch salt
- 1 tsp cinnamon
- Optional, chocolate chips or walnuts

Method:

1. Mash bananas. Whisk in eggs, butter, sugar, yogurt.
2. Stir in dry ingredients.
3. Pour into 4 mini loaf pans (greased).
4. Bake at 350 for 30 min.
5. Cool. Wrap individually. Freeze.

Swap notes: Add zucchini for hidden vegetable. Use coconut oil for dairy-free.

29. Trail-mix portion bags

The car snack. The diaper-bag snack.

Yield: 10 bags **Prep:** 10 min **Refrigerator life:** 1 month **One-handed verdict:** yes

Ingredients (mix and match):

- 2 cups roasted almonds
- 1 cup cashews
- 1 cup pumpkin seeds
- 1 cup dried cranberries or raisins
- 1 cup dark chocolate chips
- 1 cup coconut flakes (optional)

Method:

1. Mix everything in a big bowl.
2. Portion 1/2 cup into small zip bags.
3. Store in pantry or fridge.

Note: Skip nuts if allergens in household.

30. Coconut-mango lassi pops

A small joy. Cold + sweet + protein.

Yield: 8 pops **Prep:** 10 min **Total:** 10 min + freeze overnight **Freezer life:** 2 months **One-handed verdict:** yes, very

Ingredients:

- 2 cups Greek yogurt
- 1 can coconut milk
- 2 cups frozen mango
- 1/4 cup honey
- 1 tsp cardamom
- 1 tsp vanilla

Method:

1. Blend everything.
2. Pour into popsicle molds.
3. Freeze overnight.

Swap notes: Swap mango for strawberry, banana, or any frozen fruit. Add saffron for the Indian version.

The freezer map

What goes where. Print this. Tape to the freezer door.

TOP SHELF

Easy-reach, eaten first

- Breakfast burritos
- Smoothie packs
- Cookies + energy bites
- Mini banana loaves

MIDDLE SHELF

The dinners

- Soups + stews (flat-frozen bags)
- Curries + bowls
- Casseroles (full or portioned)

BOTTOM SHELF

Long-term

- Backup soups
- Bone broth
- Frozen fruit + vegetables (not for these recipes)

FREEZER DOOR

- Ice + lassi pops
- Small things

LABEL EVERYTHING:

- What it is + date frozen + reheat instructions
- Use masking tape + Sharpie. Forever method.

Reheating reference table

WHAT	HOW	TIME
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Soup, stew, curry (frozen)	Microwave, defrost then heat	10-12 min total
Soup, stew, curry (thawed)	Microwave or stovetop	5 min
Casserole (frozen, whole)	375 oven, covered	45-60 min
Casserole (frozen, portion)	Microwave	8-10 min
Breakfast burrito	Microwave + flip	2-3 min
Pancakes	Toaster	1 min
Cookies, energy bites	Eat from frozen, or thaw	10 min Instant
Smoothie pack	Blender + 1 cup liquid	60 sec
Lassi pop	Eat	Immediate

A final note

You made it through the cooking day. Or your partner did. Or your mother did. Or three friends and a meal train did.

Either way, the freezer is full. The next eight weeks have food in them. That is one less thing to worry about during the season of "I have not eaten since lunch."

The cookbook will not solve everything. The hour from 4pm to 7pm is still hard. The 3am feed is still 3am. The week the baby is sick is still the week the baby is sick.

But you will eat warm food. With one hand. While someone tiny falls asleep on your chest.

That is the cookbook doing its job.

With care, Maya



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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